

**Price Watch**

This month, we check out the prices of tablets from four price different categories.

**Killer Rigs**

There is a lot of satisfaction in building your own rig. Use our Killer Rigs to build a PC no matter what the budget.

# Of buying secondhand stuff

We show you how to go about and invest in used gadgets.

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**T**he digital age is also the age of excess. Look all around you and you'll see it for yourself. Everyone's buying tons of new gadgets than anyone ever imagined. But do you know another result of all that incessant technology buying spree? A lot of second-hand gadgets that are ready to be off-loaded into the second-hand market for others to purchase and try. Should you be one of these potential buyers of second-hand tech? The answer is a bit more complicated than a mere yes or no. Let's set some ground rules to begin with.

## How old is the device?

The electronics goods market is all about striking the right balance between how old a product is versus its cost – the older the product, the cheaper its cost, and vice versa. Unlike the automobile market, there are very few gadgets that last as long as cars. If you're buying a second-hand smartphone, tablet or laptop PC, I recommend buying products that are only up to a year old. Products like DSLR cameras, display monitors, wireless routers, graphics cards, television sets, and speakers, have greater shelf life in comparison, and therefore you can get away with purchasing even 2-3 year old products in these categories, if you find them at a bargain price.

## Physical condition

As much as possible, avoid purchasing second-hand products without having a chance to physically inspect them. Photos

and videos posted on websites don't tell the complete story of the life of a gadget, the trials and tribulations it's endured. Use websites and forums dedicated to second-hand gadgets trade to locate deals that are in your vicinity, contact the seller, and try and get to see the product before purchasing it, if possible. I know this can be cumbersome at times, but doing this is for your own good, trust me. In the case of a phone, try and verify if all its physical buttons work properly; play with its keypad and touchscreen to ensure there are no dead spots there, and most importantly check for signs of tampering – missing screws, scratch marks on its back panel, messy internals, etc. – to know whether the product has been serviced through its lifetime.

## Warranty

The single most important criteria that has a direct impact on the cost of a second-hand gadget is whether or not it is in warranty. To that effect, always try to have a copy of the original bill of purchase or the original box with which the product was shipped and sold by its manufacturer,

while purchasing a second-hand gadget. This is the only way to know for sure as to how old the gadget really is. Whether you're a buyer or seller of second-hand goods, always remember that products that have an original bill and box-packaging are sold and purchased the most.

## Purchasing avenue

Just like e-commerce websites, online portals specializing in second-hand gadgets sale (OLX, Quikr, Ebay, etc), should be looked at equal amount of scrutiny. Hope for the best, but plan for the worst. Read their terms and conditions carefully. What happens when you aren't happy with the second-hand gadget you purchased? Does the portal protect buyers or sellers or both? For tech forum-based shopping, usually the buyers and sellers of tech products are in the know about what they're getting into, so there isn't much scope for discontent on either side of the table. Admins of such forums have a voluminous guideline and whetting process before they allow their turf to be used for trade / barter, if at all they do, to protect their users and reputation. **d**

